

# Free AI Fluency Starter

A public starter path for people who want a clear, non-intimidating first step into LLMs, prompting, safe practice, and practical review habits.

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| <b>Format</b>   | Self-guided webpage and downloadable PDF companion, designed as a gentle entry point before a team briefing or coached workshop. |
| <b>Level</b>    | Level 0: orientation and first safe practice                                                                                     |
| <b>Audience</b> | Individuals, leaders, and teams who are curious about AI but want plain-language basics before committing to training.           |

## Learner outcomes

- Understand what LLMs do, why they can be useful, and why their answers still need human review.
- Use a simple prompt structure for common tasks such as drafting, summarizing, planning, and asking better questions.
- Practice with non-sensitive examples while keeping patient, customer, employee, legal, financial, and proprietary data out of public AI tools.
- Decide whether the next best step is self-practice, one-on-one coaching, a team briefing, or a structured workshop.

## Guiding questions

- What can an LLM help me draft, reframe, summarize, or plan?
- What information should stay out of public AI tools?
- How do I tell whether an AI answer is useful enough to keep working with?
- Which everyday task would be a safe first place to practice?

## Readiness checks

- Can explain what an LLM is without technical jargon.
- Can write a prompt with context, task, audience, and constraints.
- Can name at least three kinds of data that should not be pasted into public tools.
- Can identify when an output needs outside verification or human approval.

## Research-backed adoption practices

- Start with public, fictional, or anonymized examples so skill building does not depend on risky data.
- Treat AI output as a draft or suggestion until a person has checked facts, assumptions, tone, and missing context.
- Keep a small practice log that records what worked, what failed, and what had to be verified elsewhere.
- Choose first experiments from ordinary work: drafting, summarizing, planning, learning, or question generation.

## Curriculum modules

### LLMs in plain language

A beginner-friendly explanation of how large language models respond to prompts, what they are useful for, and where they become unreliable.

### The first prompting loop

A reusable pattern for giving context, asking for a draft, checking the result, and requesting a revision without overtrusting the output.

### Safe public-tool practice

A practical boundary-setting module that keeps sensitive or proprietary details out of public tools while still making room to learn.

### Review before use

A lightweight review habit for checking accuracy, tone, assumptions, missing context, and decisions that need a human owner.

### Choosing a next step

A closing module that helps learners identify one useful, low-risk task to practice and one question to bring to a trainer or manager.

## Session flow

### Orient

Start with a plain-language explanation of LLMs, prompts, outputs, and why confident-sounding answers still need review.

### Try

Use a neutral sample task to practice context, constraints, tone, examples, and follow-up questions.

### Review

Check the result for accuracy, usefulness, assumptions, missing context, and whether a human should verify it.

### **Choose**

Name one safe workflow to practice and one boundary the learner will keep in mind.

## **Practice labs**

### **Rewrite a neutral paragraph**

Practice asking for tone and audience changes using public, non-sensitive text.

### **Summarize public information**

Turn a public article or generic meeting note into a summary, then identify what still needs verification.

### **Plan a simple task**

Ask AI for a checklist, timeline, or agenda, then revise it to fit real constraints.

### **Critique the output**

Use a review prompt to find weak assumptions, vague wording, and missing context.

## **1-2 hour utility projects**

These short projects are designed to help individuals experience practical AI utility while keeping inputs safe and human review visible.

## **How to choose a strong first project**

- Real work, low risk: choose a task people already recognize, but keep inputs public, fictional, or sanitized.
- Clear walk-away artifact: produce a brief, agenda, checklist, glossary, comparison table, or reusable prompt sequence.
- Visible judgment step: check claims, name uncertainty, revise tone, or decide what should remain human-led.
- Transferable habit: practice a pattern the learner can reuse later, such as giving context, comparing outputs, or verifying before relying.

### **Learning Sprint (60-75 minutes)**

Turn a confusing topic into a private tutor session.

**Walk-away artifact:** A one-page explainer, a short quiz, a glossary, and a list of what to verify elsewhere.

**Safe input:** Use a public topic, a public article, or a concept you want to understand. Avoid private client, patient, employee, or proprietary material.

- Ask for a plain-language explanation at your current level.
- Request examples, analogies, common misconceptions, and a five-question quiz.
- Ask what claims need source checking before you rely on them.

**Starter prompt:** Teach me [topic] as a smart beginner. Start with a plain-language explanation, then give examples, common misconceptions, a short glossary, a five-question quiz, and a list of claims I should verify with reliable sources.

### **Decision Clarity Brief (75-90 minutes)**

Use AI to make a decision easier to think about without outsourcing the decision.

**Walk-away artifact:** A comparison table, assumptions list, pre-mortem, missing-information checklist, and final decision questions.

**Safe input:** Use a personal, public, fictional, or sanitized decision. Keep confidential finances, contracts, medical, legal, or customer details out of public tools.

- Describe the options, constraints, values, and what would count as success.
- Ask AI to compare options and surface assumptions instead of choosing for you.
- Run a pre-mortem and identify what a human should check before acting.

**Starter prompt:** Help me think through this decision without deciding for me: [safe decision context]. Create criteria, compare options, name assumptions, run a pre-mortem, list missing information, and end with questions I should answer myself.

### **Meeting Prep Kit (60-90 minutes)**

Turn a rough meeting idea into a more useful conversation.

**Walk-away artifact:** A meeting agenda, prep questions, likely tensions, decision points, and a follow-up email template.

**Safe input:** Use fictional or sanitized meeting context. Do not paste private attendee notes, personnel details, patient data, customer records, or proprietary plans into public tools.

- Give AI the purpose, audience, desired outcome, and any safe background.
- Ask for an agenda, questions, risks, and decisions to clarify.
- Revise the agenda for tone, time, and who needs to review it.

**Starter prompt:** Using this fictional or sanitized meeting context, create a focused agenda, prep questions, likely tensions, decision points, and a follow-up email template. Mark anything that needs human confirmation: [context].

### **Writing Upgrade Studio (60 minutes)**

See how AI can draft, critique, and revise with you in a loop.

**Walk-away artifact:** A stronger email, memo, bio, announcement, or short article with a revision history and review checklist.

**Safe input:** Use a rough draft that contains no sensitive personal, client, patient, employee, legal, financial, or proprietary details.

- Ask for a first rewrite for a specific audience and tone.
- Ask AI to critique its own draft for clarity, claims, tone, and missing context.
- Request a final revision and make the last edits yourself.

**Starter prompt:** Improve this rough draft for [audience] with a [tone] tone. Then critique your revision for clarity, unsupported claims, missing context, and anything a human should verify before sending: [safe draft].

### Research Compass (90-120 minutes)

Use AI to plan research before you read, search, or cite.

**Walk-away artifact:** A research question map, search terms, source categories, red flags, and verification plan.

**Safe input:** Use a public topic or general business question. Do not ask AI to invent citations or make final claims without sources.

- Ask AI to turn a broad topic into better questions and search terms.
- Request source categories, possible biases, and missing perspectives.
- Use the output as a reading plan, then verify claims in actual sources.

**Starter prompt:** Help me plan research on [public topic]. Create key questions, search terms, source types to seek, likely blind spots, red flags, and a verification checklist. Do not make final claims without sources.

### Workflow Recipe Builder (90-120 minutes)

Turn one repeated task into a reusable AI-assisted workflow.

**Walk-away artifact:** A workflow recipe with inputs, prompt sequence, review gates, human owner, and when-not-to-use guidance.

**Safe input:** Choose a recurring task and describe it generally or with fictional examples. Keep sensitive operational data out of public tools.

- Map the task into steps, inputs, outputs, review points, and handoffs.
- Ask AI where it can help and where human judgment should stay in charge.
- Create a repeatable prompt sequence and a review checklist.

**Starter prompt:** Turn this recurring task into a safe AI-assisted workflow recipe: [task]. Include purpose, safe inputs, prompt sequence, review checkpoints, human decision points, risks, and when not to use AI for this task.

### Professional Profile Refresh (75-90 minutes)

Use AI as a coach for describing your work more clearly.

**Walk-away artifact:** A refreshed bio, resume bullet options, interview talking points, and confidence-building practice questions.

**Safe input:** Use a sanitized career summary or fictionalized role description. Do not include private employer data, references, compensation, or confidential projects.

- Give AI a safe summary of your work, audience, and desired tone.
- Ask for clearer positioning, bullet options, and examples of evidence to add.
- Roleplay interview questions and revise anything that feels inflated or inaccurate.

**Starter prompt:** Using this sanitized professional summary, help me describe my work more clearly. Draft a short bio, five resume bullet options, three interview talking points, and questions I should answer to make the claims more accurate: [summary].

### Personal Planning Co-Pilot (60-75 minutes)

Use AI to turn vague goals into a realistic plan you can actually follow.

**Walk-away artifact:** A one-week plan, prioritized task list, obstacle plan, review ritual, and next-action checklist.

**Safe input:** Use personal goals and constraints that are not private, medical, financial, legal, or deeply sensitive.

- Describe the goal, constraints, time available, and what has made it hard.
- Ask AI for a practical plan with tradeoffs and small next actions.
- Review the plan yourself and remove anything unrealistic or intrusive.

**Starter prompt:** Help me turn this goal into a realistic one-week plan: [safe goal]. Ask clarifying questions if needed, then create priorities, daily actions, likely obstacles, a review ritual, and a simple checklist.

## Tangible cases

### Public article summary

**Situation:** A learner wants to understand a public article, newsletter, or announcement without losing the main ideas.

**Learner task:** Use AI to summarize the text, then mark which claims still need source checking before sharing.

**Starter prompt:** Summarize the following public text for a beginner. Give me five key points, three terms to define, and a short list of claims I should verify before I rely on the summary: [paste public text].

### Fictional email draft

**Situation:** A professional wants to practice drafting an email without using client, patient, employee, or proprietary details.

**Learner task:** Draft from a fictional scenario, revise tone, and decide what a human should edit before sending.

**Starter prompt:** Using this fictional scenario, draft a warm professional email. Keep it concise, avoid promises, and include a checklist of details a human should confirm before sending: [fictional scenario].

### First practice plan

**Situation:** A curious learner needs a low-pressure way to keep practicing after the starter session.

**Learner task:** Choose one safe weekly task, define boundaries, and keep a short log of useful and unreliable outputs.

**Starter prompt:** Help me design a one-week AI practice plan using only public or fictional information. Include one task per day, a safety reminder, and a simple log format for what worked, what failed, and what I checked.

## Prompt library

### Plain-language explanation

Explain [AI concept] for a smart beginner. Use an everyday analogy, name two useful applications, and name two reasons I should not overtrust the output.

### Starter prompt builder

Turn my rough request into a stronger prompt. Ask me for missing context first. Then produce a prompt with task, audience, context, constraints, and review criteria.

### Output review

Review this AI-generated draft. Identify unsupported claims, vague wording, missing context, possible bias, tone problems, and anything that needs human verification: [draft].

### Safe practice chooser

Given these possible practice tasks, sort them into safe public practice, use caution, and do not use in a public tool. Explain the reason for each category: [task list].

## Materials to develop

- Free AI fluency starter guide
- Basic prompting loop worksheet
- Public-tool safety checklist
- Output review checklist
- First safe workflow practice log

## Diagram candidates

These are intentionally left as candidate visuals until diagram parameters are chosen.

- Beginner LLM session loop: ask, inspect, revise, verify
- Safe practice boundary map for public AI tools
- First workflow chooser: draft, summarize, plan, or critique
- Responsible adoption loop: learn, practice, review, apply

## Follow-up work

- Keep a one-week practice log using only non-sensitive examples.
- Collect three questions that would benefit from coaching or a team discussion.
- Choose one recurring task that may become a future workflow workshop candidate.



## Session design reminders

- Keep examples non-sensitive and realistic.
- Emphasize education, judgment, review, and careful experimentation.
- Do not promise legal, medical, compliance, cybersecurity, or automation outcomes.
- Name when a stronger tool, private environment, or policy decision is needed before proceeding.

## API and tool boundary

This curriculum companion does not require an API call. Any secure password protection, private client portal, or live AI workflow exercise that transmits data to an external model should be reviewed before implementation.